100 Days of Linux - Day 059

Title: Boosting Productivity with Aliases

Today's Goal
Learn how to create, use, remove, and permanently save command aliases in Linux.

Why This Matters
Aliases save time by replacing long commands with short, memorable shortcuts. Developers, data engineers, and Linux administrators use them every day.

Commands of the Day: alias & unalias

Common Syntax:
alias
alias ll='ls -lah'
alias gs='git status'
unalias ll
nano ~/.bashrc (save aliases permanently)
source ~/.bashrc

Common Uses:
ll → ls -lah
cls → clear
update → sudo apt update && sudo apt upgrade

Beginner Lesson
An alias is a shortcut for another command. Aliases created in the current terminal disappear when the terminal closes unless you save them in **~/.bashrc** and reload it with **source ~/.bashrc**.

Practice Questions

1. List all aliases currently available in your terminal.
2. Create an alias named ll that runs 'ls -lah'. Test it.
3. Create an alias named cls that runs the clear command. Test it.
4. Remove the ll alias using unalias, then verify that it no longer exists.
5. Display your current working directory after completing today's tasks.

Hints

Run the alias command without arguments to list all aliases. Remember to test each alias after creating it.

Mini Challenge

Create aliases named home, docs, and update. Test each alias. Then save at least one alias permanently in ~/.bashrc and reload it using source ~/.bashrc.

Common Mistakes
Forgetting quotes around the command when creating an alias or expecting temporary aliases to remain after reopening the terminal.

Did You Know?
Many Linux users customize their shell with dozens of aliases to speed up repetitive tasks.

Pro Tip
Keep your aliases simple, meaningful, and easy to remember. Avoid overriding important system commands.

Answer Key (Instructor Only)
Q1: alias
Q2: alias ll='ls -lah' && ll
Q3: alias cls='clear' && cls
Q4: unalias ll && alias
Q5: pwd

Homework
Create five useful aliases for commands you use often. Save them in ~/.bashrc and verify they work in a new terminal session.

Next Day Preview
Tomorrow you'll learn package management with apt, including updating package lists, installing software, upgrading packages, and removing applications.